Abdullah Al Zahid

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SUMMARY

Transportation engineer with a master's degree and four years across municipal transportation planning, GO rail service planning and consulting. Runs studies from scoping to recommendations, analyzes data and options, and writes the reports, briefing notes and presentations that turn analysis into decisions.

EXPERIENCE

Assistant Planner, Transportation Planning

City of Toronto | January 2024 – present

- Run assigned studies from scoping through to recommendations, writing the briefing notes that come out of them and presenting to planners, engineers and managers in other divisions.
- Analyze travel and network data, including several years of the Transportation Tomorrow Survey, to establish where capacity falls short and what that means for future service and investment.
- Coordinate with divisions, consultants, applicants and outside agencies whose priorities conflict, and work issues through to a position everyone can act on.
- Built the Transportation Data Dashboard, replacing a report rebuilt by hand each quarter with one validated source the division reports from, and saw the change through to adoption.

Transportation Planner, Simulation and Modelling

Metrolinx, Service Design | February 2023 – January 2024

- Ran OpenTrack simulations of GO rail services to establish what proposed operating and infrastructure changes would do to run times, reliability and recovery before they were taken forward.
- Worked with schedulers, operations staff and engineers on service design decisions and presented the evidence behind them.
- Built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and produced summaries of speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.
- Set up a command line workflow so temporary and permanent slow orders could be pre-simulated in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours.

Graduate Transportation Planner

Mott MacDonald | January – February 2023

- Short consulting placement on Ontario Line work. Ran traffic simulations to estimate how construction staging would affect surrounding streets, and prepared the supporting material for the project team.

Graduate Research Assistant

University of Alberta | January 2020 – August 2022

- Master's research on how road networks perform during emergency evacuations, using macroscopic (LWR) and agent-based (MATSim) models.
- Worked with large travel datasets and wrote up results for readers without a modelling background.

SKILLS

Options analysis and evidence-based recommendations. Reports, briefing notes and presentations for senior decision-makers. Research and data analysis: Python (Pandas, NumPy), SQL and advanced Excel. ArcGIS Pro and QGIS. OpenTrack, VISSIM, Synchro and MATSim. Word, Excel and PowerPoint.

EDUCATION

MSc, Transportation Engineering — University of Alberta, 2022

BSc, Civil Engineering — Bangladesh University of Engineering and Technology, 2018

BSc, Computer Science — University of British Columbia, in progress (2025–2027)